

KYLE GAARDER

Senior Product Manager | Consumer Experience | Retention

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SUMMARY

Experience designer who builds complete customer journeys from scratch. Designed the entire resident experience at a coliving property - onboarding, engagement, and retention - achieving 94% occupancy for 19 months. I obsess over experience, test constantly, and measure success by whether people come back.

For Hipcamp: I obsess over experience and measure success by whether people come back — 94% retention for 19 months through end-to-end experience design.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed complete customer experience from scratch - onboarding, engagement, conflict resolution
- Built retention engine sustaining 94% occupancy for 19 months through experience iteration
- Ran 48 community dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 programs, synthesizing feedback into improvements
- Executed A/B testing on pricing and stay-length models, driving 48% revenue lift at 94% occupancy
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY through experience-driven optimization
- Built insights engine via member interviews and events, turning patterns into product decisions

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots outreach and validation
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand user needs and journey pain points
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led consumer experience development across strategy, ops, and product in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Complete CX from Scratch

Designed end-to-end customer experience - onboarding, engagement, retention, and resolution



94% Retention via Experience

Experience-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months



48% Revenue via Experiments

A/B tested pricing and engagement programs driving 48% annual revenue growth



Investor Pilot Secured

Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states



Demand Pipeline Built

Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Consumer Experience Design

Retention & Engagement

User Research & Synthesis

A/B Testing & Experiments

Journey Mapping Onboarding

Stakeholder Management Analytics

Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0